

LINKED SIBS AND PRIVILEGED FAMILIARITY • SIBS AND NAMES

Puberty And Initiation

Clans

Clans

Between certain sibs there exists privileged familiarity or a joking relationship, as, for example, between the Wamangi and the Wabunga. On asking an Mbunga for the origin of the joking relationship between the Wamangi and the Wabunga, I was told the following story. One day an Mbunga was making a  journey (an *mbunga* is a “traveler”), when he found a *mangi* (a dry pea-like shell with seeds inside, which when shaken makes a rattling noise). He considered it a useful instrument for his *ngoma* (band). Of course, in order to use it properly he had to call in the aid of the Wamangi sib, and thus it came about that the Wamangi formed part of the Wabunga *ngoma*. As a matter of fact, it is the Wamangi who play the drums when an Mbunga dies, and vice versa.

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¹ The Wachiro and Wamangi do not appear under these names as such in Father Wallis' list of Waluguru sibs, PRIMITIVE MAN, 1934, 758–59. The Wachiro, from data on *Mtala* names sent by Father McVicar, appear to be the Magari sib in the Wallis list. The Wamangi may be the Mzima sib, to judge from the meaning of the two words.—EDITOR.

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



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